A Beginner's Guide to Signing Forms & Releases

Welcome to the Carte Blanche Forms Hub! Signing legal releases might sound like dry paperwork, but we've made the whole process fast, easy, and completely paper-free. Here's everything you need to know in plain English.

> ☆ **The Golden Rule: Two Signatures Needed!**
> A release form is only legally valid once **both** people have signed: the **Contributor** (interviewee or guest) and the **Producer** (you!).
> **To save everyone time and energy, our system only emails the final form to `release@carteblanche.co.za` after everyone has signed.**

Which Way Should You Sign?

IF YOUR SITUATION IS...	USE THIS OPTION	HOW IT WORKS IN PRACTICE
Contributor is not with you (or prefers using their own phone)	**1. Share a Link** *(WhatsApp, Email, QR)*	You send them a link → They sign on their phone → You get an email to review and countersign → Sent to Legal automatically!
Standing with them on shoot	**2. Sign Together on One Device**	Open the form on your tablet or phone → Turn on *"Producer Present"* → Both sign on screen → Done on the spot!
Out in the bush with no signal	**3. Offline PDF Backup**	Download a blank PDF before you leave → Sign on an iPad or print it out → Email it when you get back online.

Accessing the Forms Hub

Go to `https://cb-deliverables.web.app/` (the new CARP) and click on the pink card titled **Legal & Production Forms**.

Quick Form Picker:

- **Participant Release** (Interviewees)
- **Minor Release** (Children)
- **Location Agreement** (Venues)
- **Footage Release** (Third-Party Footage)
- **Music Agreement** (Non-Library Music)
- **Insert Sheet** (Interviewees Straps and Titles / Credit Straps)

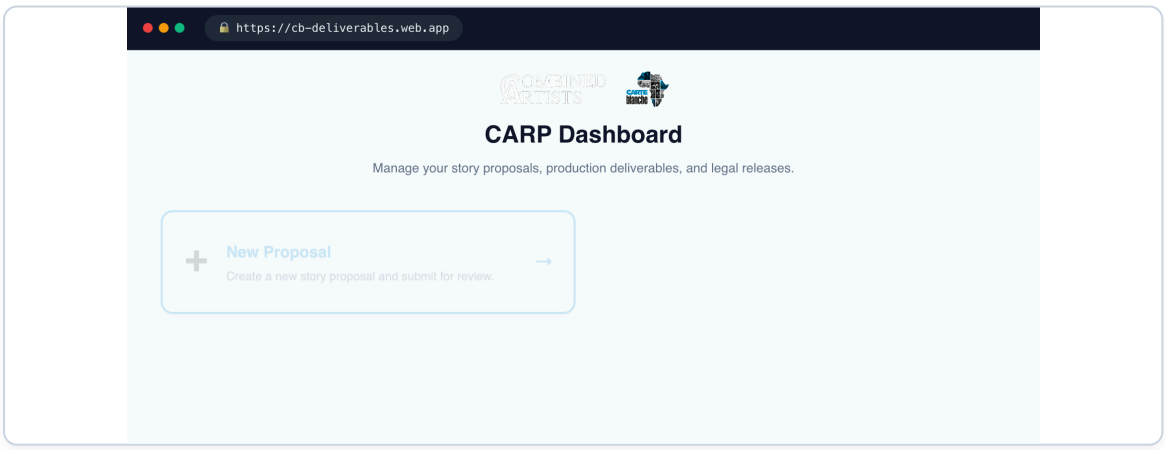


Figure 1: On the CARP Dashboard (https://cb-deliverables.web.app/), click the pink Legal & Production Forms card to open the Forms Hub.

Method 1: Sending a Link to a Contributor (Most Popular)

Use this to easily share a form to be signed with your case study, expert or source. You can share the form as follows:

- **WhatsApp the link**
- **Copy the link** to send on platforms other than WhatsApp
- **QR Code** (for your case study to scan with their phone)
- **Email the link**

1 Click "Share Online Form with Participant"

On the Forms Hub, find the agreement you need (e.g. *Participant Release*) and tap the green **"Share Online Form with Participant"** button.

2 Fill in Story Details & Dispatch

Pop in the **Story Name**, **Commissioning Number** (e.g. `2026-CB-042`), and your Producer email so the final approval comes to your inbox.

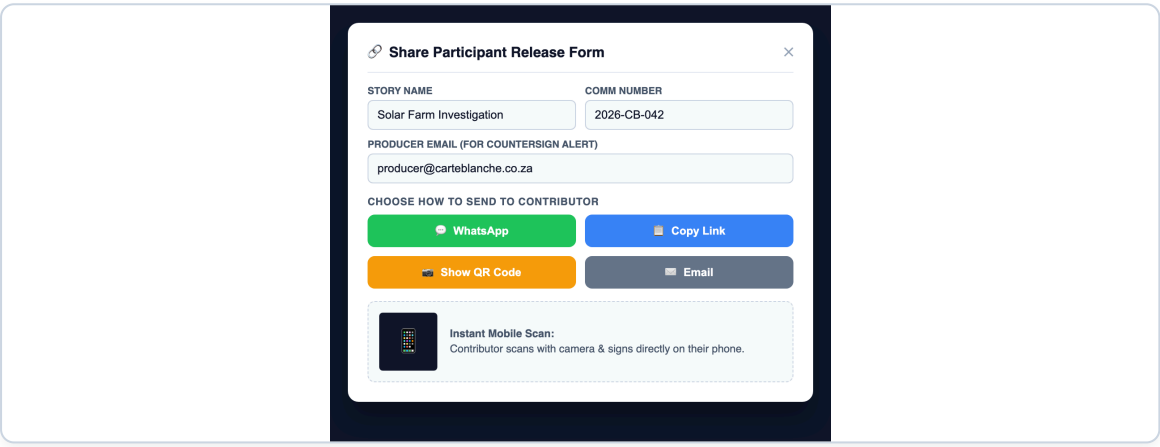


Figure 2: The Share dialogue box. WhatsApp, direct link, QR code, and email options ready for instant dispatch.

3 What the Contributor Does on Their Phone

The contributor opens the link on their smartphone, fills in their details (full name, ID/passport, telephone, and residential address), draws their signature with a finger, and taps submit.

The agreement is saved and held securely in pending status. It is not sent to legal yet.

4 You Sign the Final Approval (Countersign)

You will receive an automated email: `[Countersign Required] Participant Release – [Story Name]`. Click the green **"Review & Countersign"** button in your email to open the portal:

1. Review the contributor's verified details and digital signature.
2. Draw your signature in the Producer Countersignature box.
3. Tap **"Approve & Submit to Legal"**.



Figure 3: Your one-click review screen showing the contributor's verified submission and your countersignature box.

🎉 Bingo — You're done!

The server automatically compiles both signatures into a neat, legally binding PDF and emails copies to `release@carteblanche.co.za`, to your inbox, and to the contributor.

Method 2: Signing Together in Person (On Location)

If you're out filming on location with your contributor and have an iPad, tablet, or phone handy, you can do the whole thing together in under two minutes.

1 Open the Form on Location & Turn on "Producer Present"

On the Forms Hub, tap **"Fill Online"** on the form you need. Enter the shoot details, scroll down, and flip the switch: **"Producer Present? Sign Together Now"**. This activates dual signature pads!



Figure 4: Signing together on one device with dedicated boxes for both the Contributor and Producer.

2 Sign & Submit on the Spot

Hand the device to your contributor to fill in their details and sign → Take the device back and draw your producer countersignature → Tap **"Sign & Submit Agreement"**.

✓ The completed form goes straight to `release@carteblanche.co.za` immediately!

Method 3: The Offline Backup (When You Have No Signal)

Headed to a remote game reserve, a boat at sea, or anywhere without cell reception? Don't worry, we've got you covered.

Download a Blank Fillable PDF Before You Go

Before you leave the office or hotel Wi-Fi, tap the grey **"Blank PDF"** button under the form you need on the Forms Hub. Save it to your phone or tablet.

- **Fill it digitally:** Open it in Apple Books or Adobe Acrobat and let them sign using an Apple Pencil or finger.
- **Good old paper:** Or print out a couple of physical copies before your trip and sign with a pen.
- **Sending it in:** Once you're back in cellphone or Wi-Fi range, email the signed PDF or a clear photo of the form to `release@carteblanche.co.za`.

Quick Decision Cheat Sheet

Remote Contributor

1. Click *"Share Online Form"*
2. Send link via WhatsApp or email
3. They sign on their phone
4. You get an email & tap review
5. You sign to approve
6. → **Sent straight to Legal!**

Standing With Them

1. Click *"Fill Online"*
2. Turn on *"Producer Present"*
3. They sign on your device
4. You sign on same device
5. Tap Submit
6. → **Sent straight to Legal!**

No Cell Signal

1. Click *"Blank PDF"*
2. Download before leaving
3. Sign on tablet or paper
4. Get back to signal
5. Email copy to Legal
6. → **Sent straight to Legal!**

FOUR HANDY TIPS FOR BEGINNERS:

• **Anyone under 18?** Always use the **Minor Release**. By South African law and BCCSA broadcasting rules, a parent or legal guardian must provide their details and sign.
• **Using someone else's footage or music?** Use the **Footage Release** or **Music Agreement** so Carte Blanche has the legal licence to air it.
• **Commissioning Numbers:** Always pop in your Comm # (like `2026-CB-042`) so the archive team can instantly match the paperwork to your story.
• **Stuck or unsure?** Give production management or the legal desk a shout — we're always happy to help!